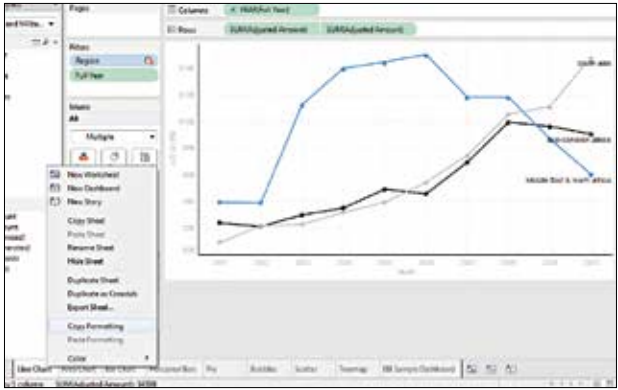




Reuse formatting to save time or to maintain a modulated look

tions. Tableau has the ability to let users create a sample formatting workbook and they can easily copy the created formatting from one sheet to another, as long as the data sets are somewhat similar. When you're creating a new viz and are ready to incorporate your premade template, open your style template workbook. Locate the sheet with the formatting you want to utilise, right-click on the tab at the bottom of the screen and select 'Copy Formatting'. Then you can head over to the new viz, locate the sheet which you want the premade formatting on and 'Paste Formatting'. This is an excellent practice when you want to standardise a certain look across workbooks made by all the members in your team.

YOUR DATA SOURCE DOESN'T NEED TO BE PERFECT

Not only is Tableau a very capable data visualisation software, but it is also a powerful data management and clean up tool. Your data source doesn't need to be absolutely perfect before you import it into Tableau. Going through a large data set and making sure everything is in order to be read and displayed accurately is an extremely tedious process. Even if your data is in less

than ideal condition, you can bring it over to Tableau. The software can understand data issues such as inconsistencies, missing data, and repetitive data quickly and then automatically make the necessary changes to it in order to save your time and resources. If the software finds any anomalies, it will prompt you to turn on Tableau Data Interpreter which can get to work and clean your data rapidly.

THE GRID IS YOUR FRIEND

If you are tasked with designing a report with multiple visualisations, charts and graphs, it always helps a great deal to utilise a grid layout. Additional elements such as views, filters and/or titles can also be placed in a grid format. This helps in two major ways. Firstly, this will ensure that everything

you have created and placed is symmetrical and lined up perfectly. Secondly, your report will flow smoothly and become easier to interpret. It provides a natural reading order for your dashboard which guides users in a predictable and logical manner. You can use both column or row-based flow to create a narrative that looks aesthetically-pleasing and reads well.

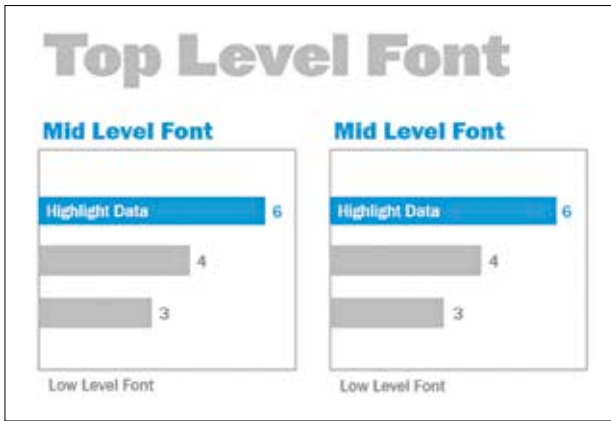
USE THE RIGHT FONTS

Typography is tremendously crucial when creating data visualisations. While using

that there are top, mid and low level fonts present. The mid-level is coloured blue to draw the viewer's attention since it will highlight what the data representation is about. Remember that colour draws eyes to itself. Apart from this, all the fonts are not too radically different from each other which helps avoid common issues such as confusion and clutter.

CREATE ANIMATED VISUALISATIONS

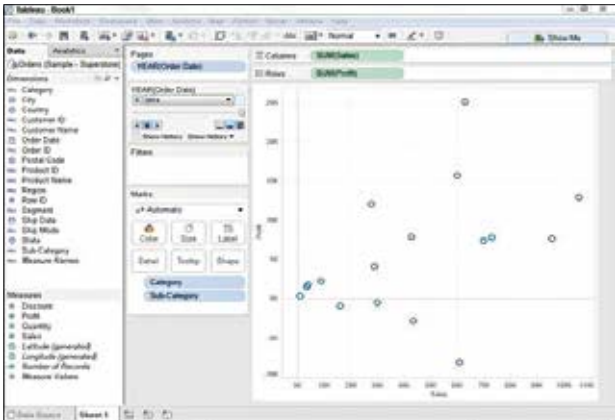
This trick is something you can adopt once you have perfected the basics of using the



Using contextually-accurate fonts translates to an easier read

too many varied fonts can certainly be tempting since they are at your disposal, it is wise to steer clear from doing this and instead, defining a clear hierarchy for your typography is beneficial. In the image above, you can see

software. It works extremely well since animations and interactive data visualisations draw in viewers simply because of the flair. As an example, let's say you're creating a visualisation of the population across the states of India during a span of years (say 10 years). The population is plotted on the Y-axis and states are displayed on the X-axis. You can make use of Tableau's Page Shelf feature to create an animated viz of how the population has changed over the years. You can check this link – <https://digit.in/AnimatedDataViz> – to see the step by step process of creating one such animated data visualisation in Tableau. 



Page Shelf feature in Tableau